

THE CONSENT GAP

Governments are quietly stitching the separate records they hold on you — health, tax, justice, benefits, census — into **one combined file**. It's legal. It's spreading worldwide. **Nobody asked you.**

56,000,000

people's census records linked to tax & benefits data in **one** UK project (96.7%)

8 + 2

countries with confirmed government use, plus the **EU** and the **UN** — and that's only who admitted it

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consent · notification · opt-out. You were never told and cannot say no

WHO USES THE TOOL (SPLINK, BUILT BY THE UK MINISTRY OF JUSTICE)

United Kingdom — deepest: national + local councils

Australia

Germany

United States

Canada

Chile

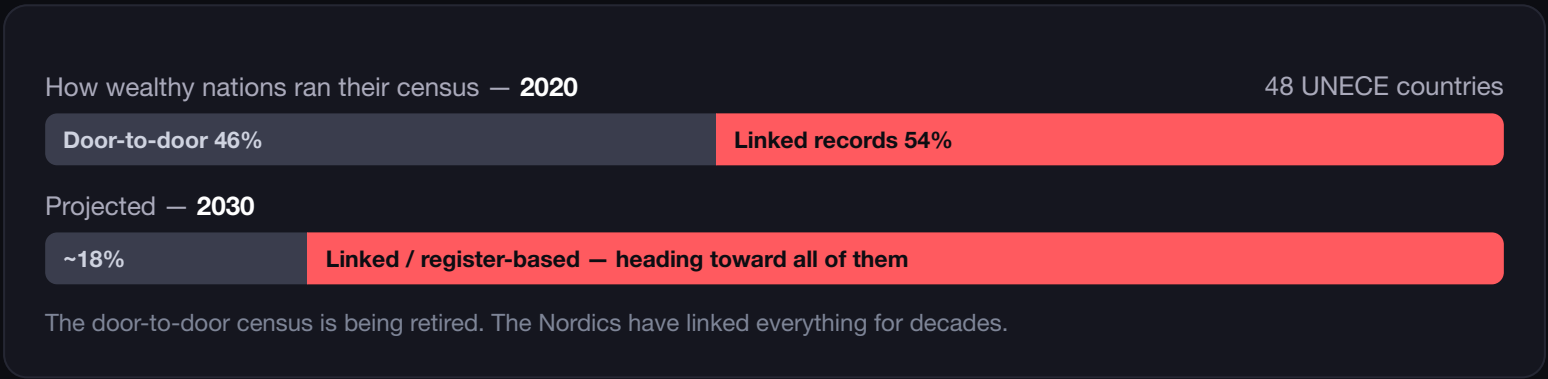
Gambia — 2024 census

Laos — children's health records

EU — Medicines Agency

UN — UNHCR (refugee data)

THE BIGGER PICTURE — THIS IS BECOMING THE NORM



The twist most people get wrong

People think Europe's privacy law (GDPR) stops this. **It doesn't — it allows it.** The law has a built-in exception that lets governments link your records without asking, and even skip telling you. Nobody broke the rules. **The rules were written to permit it.**

The government is building a single picture of you from everything it holds — legal, global, and **you were never asked.**

Sources: GOV.UK Algorithmic Transparency Records · ONS · Australian Bureau of Statistics · NHS England · Splink official documentation · UNECE 2020 census round · OECD. Every figure adversarially fact-checked. Full report & archived evidence: brandonmyers.net/writing/the-quiet-joining-up